army officers. This happened after they had complained to Sheikh Mujib about a misdemeanour by the notoriously corrupt Ghulam Mustapha, chairman of the Bangladesh Red Cross and one of one of the Sheikh's proteges. Mujib did not act against Mustapha and Dalim wanted revenge.

The R&AW founder and chief R.N. Kao was just as shocked as the Polish officials. He didn't know how the situation had changed in just four years. The reports from Dhaka arriving via telegrams and notes suggested that altogether two hundred people had died in the fighting on the first day despite stiff resistance from Mujib's personal guards. An internal confidential note suggested that a group of pro-Mujib youth had come out on the streets of Dhaka but subsided when they saw the army firing at the troublemakers. The border with India was sealed and all communications were cut except for limited telephone and telegraph services.

The internal confidential note said: 'Forsaking the path of constitutional government and peaceful change, a new government has emerged in Bangladesh with its hands stained with the blood of Sheikh Mujib, the father figure and the moving spirit and hero of the liberation struggle of Bangladesh.'

Sheikh Mujib had been friendly towards India and stood for secular principles. But close scrutiny of the events leading to the coup suggested he had been losing his charm because of widespread corruption, nepotism, violence and lawlessness in the country.

The R&AW spies stationed at Dhaka said that there was no evidence of direct foreign complicity in the coup. One fact, though, was significant. Pakistan was the first country to recognise the new regime and lost no time in offering